

Persuasive Messages Prompt #2:

SDCCU Credit Union Aztec Proud VISA® Card: Sales Letter

You have just been hired as a brand ambassador for San Diego County Credit Union. Jennifer Altec, the Special Products Marketing Manager (your supervisor) is developing several new services for members of the SDCCU family. One of those services is a specific VISA credit/debit card that would appeal to SDSU students—called the SDCCU Aztec Proud VISA Card—and she wants your help promoting it on campus.

The card offers several benefits to SDSU students. The first is a rewards program linked to purchases with the card. Each time an SDSU student uses the card, he or she will earn points. Members get one point for each dollar charged to the credit card and two points for every two dollars when they use it as a debit card. In addition, they earn triple points when they use the card for tickets for Aztec sporting events, when they buy books or supplies at Aztec Shops, and when they use the card to pay for an ARC membership.

When they accrue enough rewards, students can exchange points for brand-name merchandise, adventure trips, hotel accommodations, airline tickets or statement credits. Those benefits are listed on a dedicated SDCCU Aztec Proud website. The reward levels are low for these benefits; compared to other rewards cards, students don't have to accrue many points to earn the rewards.

The second benefit involves the card's interest rate. Jennifer has arranged that SDSU students would not be charged interest for the first year after they sign up (as long as they spend \$1,000 in the first year using the card), and a 9.9% rate as long as they are students. (There are restrictions to this promotion, but you don't need to discuss them in the letter).

Using the information above, write a sales letter that persuades incoming SDSU freshmen to join SDCCU and sign up for the card. The letter will be mailed next July, before they arrive on campus.

Guidelines

You might follow these guidelines as you draft the letter:

- Make sure you understand your audience
- Choose an appropriate combination of strategies that will best appeal to that audience
- Create an opening using that appeal that gains the reader's attention
- Build your case citing the card's benefits
- Drive toward the sale by specifying exactly what you want the students to do
- Keep the letter to one page

Resources

You'll find a discussion of each guideline listed above in our text. Review the "General Advice about Persuasion" section beginning on page 158 first, then focus on the "Sales Messages" section beginning on page 164, including all sample messages presented and discussed in that section.

Contact Information

Use standard business letter format; make up a name and address for the student.